

Explore...

Summer 2012

***The free newsletter of the
Friends of Telford Town Park***

www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org





All change at the top!

After several years as Chairman, Chris Pettman has decided to stand down and let some new brains take over the reins of the Friends. At the AGM in April Colin Thompson was voted in as Chair. Colin has been a volunteer for a number of years not only with the Friends but with the Ironbridge Lions and we are sure he will bring some fresh ideas and enthusiasm to the group. Welcome Colin and best wishes.

Telford Green Spaces Partnership is a forum of sixteen different groups who run 'Friends of ' or similar organisations which look after many of the green spaces around Telford. The group meets regularly to exchange ideas and information and is an undoubted success. The Friends are represented on the forum by our new chairman Colin Thompson.



Supported by



RICOH



Photo Competition

The Friends are currently running a photo competition for the second year following the success of the one run in 2011. The theme is **Our Beautiful Park** and photos must have been taken in the Town Park since last October. Pick up a leaflet in the Visitor Centre or see our web site for full details of how to enter. Entry is free and the prizes include a day at a Mark Sissons Birds of Prey workshop and a Ricoh CX6 digital camera. The end result will be a beautiful 2013 calendar on sale in October with great pictures of the park.

www.ricoh.com/r_dc/cx/cx6/

www.natures-images.co.uk/pages/workshops/birds-of-prey.php

FOTTP Contact details

The Visitor Centre: 01952 - 382340

Web site: www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

We hold monthly meetings in the new Park Visitor Centre every second Wednesday of the month at 6pm.



Pond Planting 13 June

The Friends have been busy assisting with the planting of over 200 pond plants with the assistance of Jason Reynolds from Simply Ecology. The Park had arranged to clear the ponds with some dredging last year before the newts climbed back in! It is hoped to encourage more wildlife back into these ponds particularly newts. The planting of these marginal plants will greatly assist that aim. These ponds and lakes, there are about a dozen in all around the park, play a vital role in the local biodiversity which gives us all the lovely creatures we can see and enjoy in the park. If you would like to help in this work, pick up a Friends joining leaflet from the Visitor Centre.

DAWLEY DAY 7 JULY 2012



Brenda Pettman from the Friends found Olympic Medal winner Dave Otley enjoying the day. Above right, Chris, Rob and Colin manning the stand. The rain held off until late on and the Friends did a lot of 'park promoting' and hopefully some new members may come of it. As always, it was a great free day out organised by Great Dawley Parish Council.

Congratulations from the Friends of Telford Town Park



The Friends were fortunate to be one of 40 or so voluntary organisations represented at the Jubilee Pageant held at RAF Cosford on Thursday the 12th July. We had a stand in one of the marquees and were kept busy all day answering questions about the park. The weather, mercifully and miraculously, was dry all day with quite a lot of sun and everyone was smiling and generally having a great day out. We should like to thank the Lord Lieutenant of Shropshire, Algernon Heber-Percy and his deputies and other staff for giving Shropshire a great day.



The Friends stand with Tracy Chiang and Brenda Pettman and Her Majesty and the Duke of Edinburgh off to lunch at the RAF Museum Visitor Centre



2013
will be the
Friends
10th anniversary

A big wildlife and nature event is being planned by the Friends to celebrate their 10th anniversary in 2013. On **Saturday the 17th August 2013** in the Queen Elizabeth 2 Arena in the Town Park, we hope to attract lots of families to come and enjoy a day out with nature. There will be lots of fun things to see and do including grass weaving, face painting, Hawks and Owls and a variety of arena displays..

Make a note in your diary for this **FREE** event, or you could buy one of the Friends calendars in October and make a note in that!



Friday 27th July another free day of holiday fun. Children can come along to a great musical workshop, make their own instruments and create a piece of music all together in a natural environment. This will be part of celebrating national **Love Parks Week**.





Parks for People



Above: The Twin Tracks site and Silkin Way learning zone.

Left: The new Multi use games area next to the Visitor Centre.

The Lottery funded Parks for People project has now delivered many superb improvements in the park. The next phase will include resurfacing much of the pathways and erecting signage and gateways. There will inevitably be more disruption but it is hoped to be kept to a minimum. It will all be worthwhile as when it is finished we will all have a much enhanced park to enjoy, both visually and with improved biodiversity. The flora and fauna of the park are in a very healthy state thanks to a lot of coppicing, replanting and more bat and bird box provision.

Please see our web site www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org for regular updates and photos.

Forthcoming event

Saturday 9th December 2012.
10.30am the Queen Elizabeth
the Second Arena, Telford's 6th
Annual Santa Fun Run in aid of
Guide Dogs and the **RNIB.**



Follow us on
TWITTER - (@fottpp)



June & July
Chelsea and
Maxell Gardens
get help
from the
Friends

The Friends have recently been busy with some horticultural training in the Chelsea Gardens very ably given by a local expert, Theresa Rham. This is all part of the Parks for People project and with the cutbacks at the Council starting to bite, the Friends are glad to be able to help keep the gardens in good order. This training and work will be ongoing well into next year, so if you fancy doing a bit of gardening in the park come along and help. Details from 01952 -382340, the park reception.

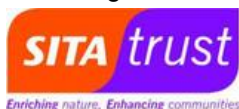


Tuesday 7th August
Teddy Bears Picnic
1pm - 3pm



This event running from 1pm until 3pm is for all children to bring a teddy to the park in the Queen Elizabeth 2 Arena to enjoy a picnic.

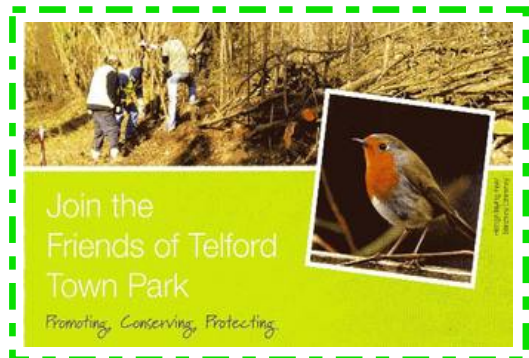
It will also be a very special day as it will also include the unveiling of the new sign to mark the protection of the Arena under the Fields in Trust scheme. The Friends have worked very hard to get this valuable space protected and we shall be there to see the sign unveiled.



Coming soon !

As part of the Southwater redevelopment there will be a brand new water play area installed in front of the new Visitor Centre during September which will be fully functional by Spring 2013. Also September will see the landscaping of the area along with the covered seating and the reinstatement of the Sensory Garden between the multi use games area and the Visitor Centre.

If you would like to join the Friends and help conserve the park, pick up a leaflet at the visitors centre. Alternatively call 01952 - 382340 and leave your contact details and we will be in touch. Or you can contact us via our website at:



www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

We hope that you have enjoyed this free newsletter generously supported by **Great Dawley Parish Council**. We should also like to thank Telford & Wrekin Council, Hollinswood & Randlay PC, Stirchley & Brookside PC, Madeley PC and Lawley & Overdale PC for their continued support of the Friends.

Please remember that if you see anything untoward in the park please call the park reception on **01952 - 382340** or if it is of a more serious nature, the non emergency **POLICE number.....101**.

For any life threatening emergencies call **999 or 112** immediately giving your location and name.

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